

E-Commerce Platform Launch

Integrated Project Charter & Management Plan | Project Coordinator Portfolio Case Study

1. Executive Summary

This simulated project coordinates the launch of a secure e-commerce platform across engineering, product catalog, payments, quality assurance, security, operations, and executive stakeholders. The project is structured as a six-week delivery effort with formal governance, measurable KPIs, controlled scope, risk management, launch readiness, and post-launch hypercare.

Metric	Target / Baseline	Final Result
Launch date	August 17, 2026	Completed on baseline date
Budget	\$90,000 + \$5,000 contingency	\$88,450 actual; 1.7% favorable variance
Final-week delivery	24 planned tasks	24 completed (100%)
Velocity	24 baseline	48 final week (+100%)
Open launch-blocking issues	0	0 at go-live

2. Business Need & Objectives

- Create a production-ready digital storefront with catalog, checkout, payment, security, and support readiness.
- Coordinate cross-functional workstreams and dependencies through a single source of truth.
- Maintain transparent executive reporting for scope, schedule, budget, quality, risk, and decisions.
- Complete launch readiness with all critical defects closed and required approvals documented.
- Establish hypercare monitoring and lessons learned for transition to steady-state operations.

3. Scope Definition

In Scope	Out of Scope
Storefront framework and responsive checkout	Native mobile application
Initial catalog configuration and validation	International market expansion
Payment gateway integration and certification	Second payment processor at initial launch
UAT, security review, deployment, hypercare	Long-term merchandising optimization
Project governance, status reporting, RAID, change control	Post-hypercare feature roadmap

4. Governance & Roles

Role	Primary Accountability	Decision / Escalation
Executive Sponsor	Funding, strategic alignment, go-live approval	Scope/budget exceptions and go-live decision
Project Coordinator	Integrated plan, meetings, actions, RAID, reporting	Escalates blockers and decision needs
Engineering Lead	Build, integration, deployment	Technical feasibility and estimates
Product Lead	Catalog, requirements, acceptance	Business acceptance and scope detail
QA Lead	Test planning, defect triage, UAT	Quality exit criteria
Security Analyst	Security evidence and approval	Security sign-off
Operations Lead	Runbook, support readiness, hypercare	Operational acceptance

5. Delivery Approach & Phase Gates

Phase	Key Activities	Exit Criteria
Initiate	Charter, stakeholders, scope, baseline	Charter approved
Plan	WBS, schedule, RACI, RAID, communications	Plan baselined
Build & Configure	Storefront, catalog, payments	Feature-complete staging build
Validate	UAT, security, defect triage	Critical defects closed; security approved
Launch	Readiness review, deployment, smoke test	Production validation complete
Hypercare & Close	Issue monitoring, transition, lessons learned	Support handoff accepted

6. Milestone Schedule

Milestone	Baseline	Actual	Variance
Charter Approved	Jul 8	Jul 8	0 days
Storefront Build Complete	Jul 24	Jul 23	-1 day
Payment Integration Complete	Jul 31	Aug 1	+1 day
UAT Complete	Aug 7	Aug 8	+1 day
Go-Live Readiness	Aug 14	Aug 14	0 days
Production Launch	Aug 17	Aug 17	0 days

7. RAID Management

RAID items are reviewed in weekly status meetings and daily during UAT/launch. Risk scoring uses Impact x Probability on a 1-5 scale. Scores of 15+ require executive visibility; launch blockers are escalated immediately.

ID	Type	Description	Score	Owner	Mitigation / Resolution
R-01	Risk	Payment certification delay	15	Engineering	Staging certification + backup processor plan
R-02	Risk	Catalog data quality	12	Product	Validation rules + sample audit
I-01	Issue	Three checkout defects in UAT	20	QA	Daily triage; critical defects fixed before gate
D-01	Dependency	Security sign-off before deployment	20	Security	Reserved review window + evidence checklist

8. Communications Plan

Audience	Artifact / Meeting	Cadence	Purpose
Core delivery team	Stand-up / blocker review	Daily	Progress, blockers, dependencies
Workstream leads	Integrated plan review	2x weekly	Schedule and cross-team coordination
Executive sponsor	Executive status update	Weekly	Health, decisions, risks, budget
QA/Product/Engineering	Defect triage	Daily during UAT	Prioritize and resolve defects
Launch team	Readiness review	T-3 days / T-1 day	Validate exit criteria and rollback readiness

9. Change Control

Change requests document business rationale, scope/schedule/budget/quality impact, recommendation, approver, and decision. Approved changes are incorporated into the baseline and communicated to affected owners. Deferred changes are moved to the post-launch backlog.

Change	Impact	Decision
Guest checkout	+3 development days; absorbed within float	Approved
Second payment processor	+2 weeks; threatens launch baseline	Deferred
Add 500 SKUs	Higher catalog-quality risk	Approved as phased upload

10. Quality & Launch Readiness

- 100% of critical checkout paths executed in UAT.
- All critical and high-severity launch-blocking defects closed before readiness approval.
- Payment authorization, capture, refund, and failure scenarios validated.
- Security evidence package reviewed before production deployment.
- Rollback steps, monitoring ownership, support runbook, and hypercare contacts confirmed.

11. KPI Framework & Outcome

KPI	How Measured	Outcome
Task completion	Completed / planned tasks by week	12 -> 24 completed per week
Velocity	Weighted completed work per week	24 -> 48 (+100%)
Issue health	Open and closed issues	0 launch blockers at go-live
Milestone adherence	Actual vs baseline	Launch on baseline date
Budget variance	(Baseline - Actual) / Baseline	1.7% favorable
Readiness	Gate criteria met / total	100% critical criteria met

12. Lessons Learned

- Reserve external certification windows early because third-party dependencies can create schedule risk even when internal work is on track.
- Daily defect triage during UAT reduces ambiguity and keeps ownership visible.
- A single integrated tracker improves handoffs across product, engineering, QA, security, and operations.
- Executive updates are most effective when they separate information from decisions required.
- Catalog validation should begin before the full load to reduce late-cycle data-quality rework.

13. Portfolio Note

This is a simulated portfolio case study designed to demonstrate practical project coordination methods, artifacts, reporting, and analysis. Metrics and scenarios are intentionally realistic but are not presented as results from an employer or client engagement.